The Curator's Brief

How to direct AI instead of operating it: the brief, the review and the daily rhythm of a founder who runs on a workforce.

Direct it. Don't operate it.

Curators direct. Passengers scroll.

The same tool gets used in two very different ways. One keeps you busy. The other gives you your time and your attention back.

The operator

Types a prompt, reads the answer, fixes it by hand, types another. Still doing every task, only faster.

The director

Writes a clear brief once, reviews the result against a standard, and lets the work move without them.

The shift is small and it changes everything. You stop asking AI for answers and start giving it a role, a goal, a standard and a handover. That is what a brief is.

AI handles the grunt work. You handle the meaning.

Five lines that replace a hundred prompts.

ROLE	Who the AI is for this job, in one line. "You are my editor for the weekly newsletter."
GOAL	What done looks like, in one sentence you could tick off.
STANDARD	What good means here: voice, length, what to avoid. Paste one example you love.
LIMITS	What it must not do or invent. Facts, claims and numbers come only from you.
HANDOVER	The format it hands back in, so the next step needs no cleanup.

BRIEF TEMPLATE (SAVE IT)

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Role: [who you are for me on this job]. Goal: [what done looks like].
Standard: [voice, length, an example to match, what to avoid].
Limits: [what you must not do or make up; ask me if you need a fact].
Handover: [exactly how to return it]. If anything here is unclear,
ask me one question before you start.
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Review like a director, not a typist.

When the work comes back, do not fix it by hand. Judge it against the standard and send it back with one clear note.

1 **Check the goal.** Is the thing actually done, or only described?

2 **Check the standard.** Would you put your name on it? If not, name the single biggest gap.

3 **Check the facts.** Anything it stated as fact that you did not give it is out.

THE NOTE BACK

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This is not there yet. The biggest gap is [one thing]. Fix only that.
Keep everything else exactly as it is, and tell me what you changed
in one line.
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SELF REVIEW FIRST

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Before you hand this back, check it against the brief: is the goal
met, does it match the standard, did you invent anything? List any
problems you find and fix them. Then hand it back.
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Twenty minutes in the director's chair.

Directing is a short daily habit, not another job. It also suits a brain that likes a clear, fast loop.

START	Five minutes. Write today's briefs for the three things that matter. Send them.
MIDDAY	Ten minutes. Review what came back. One note each, or approve.
END	Five minutes. Ask for a summary of what moved and tomorrow's three briefs, drafted for your approval.

DAILY DIRECTION

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You are my chief of staff. Here are the three outcomes I want from
today: [paste]. For each one, write a brief I can send to another AI
worker using the Role, Goal, Standard, Limits and Handover format.
Keep each brief under 80 words. Flag any outcome that is too vague to
brief.
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Three things, in order.

1 **Today:** take one task you do by hand every week and write its brief with the five lines.

2 **This week:** use that brief every time. Review with the note back, never by editing it yourself.

3 **Next week:** add a second brief, then a third. Keep the three that save you the most time.

Over a month you will have a small library of briefs, and a set of jobs that run without you operating them.

A working routine to adapt: change the words until they sound like you.

Choose which one you are.